



A Year in Review

Pupil Service Department 2020-21

First Steps...



“One atypical cultural topic identified through the site visit is the perception of miscommunication and lack of support for staff, students, and parents by Central Office administrators overseeing special education in the district.”

- Met monthly at PLCs in each building to build relationships with staff
- Met regularly with building administrators
- Attended many ETR and IEP meetings
- Supported staff with change and challenges
- Created a Google Classroom

Consistent expectations

“The need for clear communication from Central Office to building level leadership, as well as clear communication to all staff members, parents of Special Education students and community stakeholders. We recommend protocols/checklists be developed for many challenges.. For instance: when to consider 1:1 aides; how co-teaching is to be utilized at each level; the role of the IS at elementary and secondary buildings; preparation for IEP meetings.”

- This has happened from the start with consistency that follows compliance
- All staff given a special education binder
- Launch Pad



Audit recommendation D and 7

Continuum of Services



“We recommend a serious review of a gap in the elementary schools’ spectrum of services for students with disabilities. We recommend that students are placed in LREs according to the needs dictated by their IEPs, rather than matching students to services currently in place in the schools.”

- Cohesiveness in all three buildings (co-teaching, resource room, and self-contained units)

Audit Recommendation B and 6

Staffing



“Based on data from national, state, and local comparable school districts, we recommend staffing level adjustments in a few areas.”

- Anticipated hiring of an additional coordinator.
 - Instructional coach position eliminated
- Reduction of paraprofessional aides.
 - Reviewing the proper levels of service to students
 - Independence Plans
- Behavior specialists

Audit recommendation C and 5

Mental Health



“We provide a list of resources the school might want to use to help in the area of mental health and behavioral well-being guidance, consulting and placement options.”

- Red Oak Health and Wellness
- Next year adding *iCare Mentoring*

Audit recommendation G

Empowering Leadership



“Building principals need to be empowered to be engaged directly with special education within their buildings.”

- Clear direction and communication to the responsibilities for principals
- Regular meetings and/or communication regarding special education concerns addressed at a building level (PLC)
- Professional development for the administrators to support them in this endeavor (Nuts and Bolts)

Compliance



“We found concerns in the sample IEPs we viewed from the perspective of avoiding successful due process complaints against the District.”

- IEP writing professional development has been ongoing
- Plan for next year
 - Creating an Inter-rater team
 - Tiering special education staff
- Avoiding Due Process

Audit recommendation 5

Staffing



“Adjusting staffing to levels dictated by student IEP needs annually.”

- Staffing needs are based on student needs identified in IEPs.
 - Adjusting SDI minutes based on goals
 - Creation of self-contained units
 - Keeping students in-district
- Workload/caseload imbalance

Audit recommendation 8 and 20

Curriculum



“With respect to curriculum, we found it uniquely concerning the lack of consistent materials being used throughout classrooms.”

- Training for Literacy Collaborative Framework
 - Using BAS assessments and guided reading K-8
- Working with Dr. Martin

Audit recommendation 9

Case Manager Assignments



“We recommend serious consideration be given to longer as opposed to shorter assignment of case managers to their students.”

- All case managers K-12 will stay with their students for more than one year
 - Was happening everywhere except the Middle School

Audit recommendation 13

Behavior Coaches



“We recommend hiring behavior specialists within the district to support the needs of students and teachers in each building.”

- Red Oak Health and Wellness
 - Currently 2 behavior coaches
 - Next year 3 coaches
 - 1 licensed clinician
 - Next year 2 licensed clinicians
- Social Emotional Curriculum at high school
 - Catholic Charities

Settlement Agreements



“A review of available information was conducted relating to settlement agreements, due process issues and the fiscal effect of Brecksville-Broadview Heights students with disabilities attending other schools under state funding that reduces foundation funds to Brecksville-Broadview Heights.”

- Creation of units/programs to meet student needs
 - Bringing students back to the district
 - Cost savings for the district

Audit recommendation 12

District Savings



<i>2019 - 2020 ESY Spending</i>		<i>2020 - 2021 Projected ESY Spending</i> (Estimated Cost)	
Our Staff Cost	\$31,043.57	Our Staff Cost	\$40,714.88
Sendero Cost	\$11,383.50	Sendero Cost	\$4,884.00
Private Services Cost	\$62,816.50	Private Services Cost	\$13,534.25
Settlement Agreements	\$7,349.09	Settlement Agreements	\$15,450.00
Total Education Cost	\$112,592.66	Total Education Cost	\$74,583.13
Suburban	\$12,635.00	Suburban	\$10,308.00
Total Transportation	\$12,635.00	Total Transportation	\$10,308.00
2019 - 2020 Grand Total	\$125,227.66	2020 - 2021 Grand Total	\$84,891.13
	Total Yearly Saving	\$40,336.53	

District savings



<i>2019 - 2020 SpeD Spending</i>		<i>2020 - 2021 SpeD Spending</i>	
PEP Tuition	\$333,135.19	PEP Tuition	\$111,306.00
X. H. Tuition	\$74,900.00	A. W. Tuition	\$85,050.00
D. R. Tuition	\$81,884.00	D. R. Tuition	\$81,885.00
M. K. Tuition	\$79,223.20	M. K. Tuition	\$80,840.00
A. U. Tuition	\$72,000.00	A. U. Tuition	\$94,066.74
M. B. Tution	\$74,522.41	M. B. Tution	\$80,840.00
B. K. Tuition	\$20,500.00	B. K. Tuition	\$20,000.00
		C. S. Tuition	\$1,800.00
Tuition Total	\$736,164.80	Tuition Total	\$555,787.74
PEP Assist/Behavior Coach	\$239,259.00	Red Oak	\$149,500.00
America's Best	\$42,510.00	America's Best	\$13,200.00
Suburban	\$219,989.00	Suburban	\$58,297.00
Total Transportation	\$262,499.00	Total Transportation	\$71,497.00
2019 - 2020 Grand Total	\$1,237,922.80	2020 - 2021 Grand Total	\$776,784.74
	Total Yearly Saving	\$461,138.06	

What's ahead....



Plans for 2021-22 school year

- Continue with relationship building and empowering leadership
- Focus on RTI/MTSS process
 - Especially at the elementary school
- Continue addressing compliancy
- More professional development
 - All special education staff, including paraprofessionals
- Creation of special education newsletter
- Development of special education procedural handbook